



HYBRIDS **Vs** ULTRABOOKS **Vs** TABLETS



THE BATTLE OF THE PORTABLES

Portable computing is here to stay, but the correct form-factor is still a matter of contention. Which one wins? Let's find out

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The conundrum continues – is the ultrabook better for you? Is the hybrid a more attractive package? Perhaps the good old tablet is all you need. If there's one thing we've learned with the advancement in technology and evolution of products over time is that there's always a problem of plenty, and zeroing in on the right product for the right need may not always be an easy – as is the case with mobile computing devices, in recent times. It's not an easy decision to make, but we attempt to give you a better idea of what each of these three device types are especially good at.

Performance and future Proofing

If you are looking to buy a machine that doesn't really compromise on performance, an ultrabook will possibly be the best bet for you. The choice of the Core i3, Core i5 and Core i7 processor options that you can pick from are obviously dictated by the price bracket you are considering. However, remember, that these will be a lot more powerful than the Intel Clover Trail or Bay Trail CPUs that power most Windows 8 convertibles and also offer better performance than most of the processors that you get with Android tablets. No matter what others say, or whichever review you read, always remember one thing: you will just get more done on an ultrabook than on a hybrid or tablet. Period.

Also, ultrabooks usually come with generous helpings of RAM (4GB and more), which is useful as your computing demands and OS upgrades demand more system resources.

Storage is more with an ultrabook – upwards of 500GB, as opposed to



Tablets and hybrids still can't touch an ultrabook in terms of pure performance

a paltry 16GB to 128GB bundled into and offered by tablets and hybrids. For future-proofing and performance, it's obvious, ultrabooks still rule.

Score: Ultrabooks 1 - Tablets 0 - Hybrids 0

Portability

Both tablets and hybrids are obviously at an advantage here, as ultrabooks are nowhere as razor thin as the other two form factors.

If you need a device to quickly access files, play around, surf, watch videos, and generally consume more than you create (which is standard on the move behaviour) the ideal device is a tablet (with or without an additional keyboard accessory). If you need your tablets to be a little more versatile, then Windows 8 hybrids also fit in perfectly here. A tie between tablets and hybrids.

Score: Ultrabooks 1 - Tablets 1 - Hybrids 1

Battery life

While ultrabooks are themselves far superior to laptops when it comes to offering battery life per single charge, it is no secret that tablets outperform even the best ultrabook in terms of battery life. However, the hands down winner here are the Windows 8 hybrids. With two batteries – one in the tablet mode and another in the dock – you are looking at combined battery backup times well in excess of 15 hours! Truly all-day computing (on a single charge) is finally a convenient reality, thanks to hybrids.

Score: Ultrabooks 1 - Tablets 1 - Hybrids 2

Ease of use/adaptability

Technically, all three devices (tablets, hybrids and ultrabooks) are meant for pretty much the same tasks – at least as far as the basic tasks are concerned. But, some of those tasks are better done